ReturnWise

E-Commerce Return Intelligence Report

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1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes 8,000 orders from the e-commerce platform, covering 594 customers and 50 products across 6 categories. The overall return rate is 11.63% based on 7,591 eligible orders (excluding cancelled orders). Total revenue amounts to ■48,163,248.75 with an average order value of ■6,020.41.

Metric	Value
Total Orders	8,000
Return Rate	11.63%
Total Revenue	■48,163,248.75
Avg Order Value	■6,020.41
Items Returned	883
Total Refund Amount	■2,289,755.42
Cancellation Rate	5.11%

2. Dataset Overview

The dataset consists of 5 related tables: customers (600 records), orders (8000 records), order items (16418 records), products (50 records), and returns (883 records). All joins are clean with zero unmatched keys.

Order dates range from 2024-01-01 to 2025-12-31.

Note: The dataset does not contain delivery date or seller identifier fields. Delivery and seller analyses are adapted accordingly.

3. Data Quality Findings

Overall Data Quality Score: 98.0/100

The dataset has no missing values and no duplicate records across all tables. One product has a negative margin (sold below cost), which is flagged but retained as potentially legitimate.

4. Key Insights

Category Return Rates

Category	Total Items	Returned	Return Rate
Electronics	2830	161	5.69%
Books & Stationery	3959	219	5.53%
Home & Kitchen	1776	98	5.52%
Beauty & Personal Care	2132	112	5.25%
Sports & Fitness	2512	130	5.18%
Fashion	3209	163	5.08%

Return Reasons

Reason	Count	Percentage
Better Price Found Elsewhere	136	15.4%
Wrong Item Delivered	132	14.95%
Changed Mind	131	14.84%
Size/Fit Issue	126	14.27%
Quality Issue	123	13.93%
Not as Described	119	13.48%
Product Damaged	116	13.14%

5. Discount Impact Analysis

Discount Level	Total Items	Returns	Return Rate
0%	7426	405	5.45%
5%	3240	165	5.09%
10%	2513	128	5.09%
15%	1935	106	5.48%
20%	1304	79	6.06%

8. Recommendations

1. Investigate High Returns in Electronics

Finding: Electronics has the highest return rate at 5.69%

Metric: 161 returned items out of 2830 sold

Action: Review product descriptions, quality checks, and customer feedback for this category

Evidence: Based on 2830 order items — statistically meaningful sample

2. Address 'Better Price Found Elsewhere' Returns

Finding: 'Better Price Found Elsewhere' is the most common return reason (15.4%)

Metric: 136 returns

Action: Implement targeted interventions based on the specific reason type

Evidence: Consistent across 136 return instances

3. Overall Return Rate Monitoring

Finding: Overall return rate is 11.63%

Metric: 883 returns out of 7591 eligible orders

Action: Set up automated alerts for return rate changes by category and time period

Evidence: Baseline established from full dataset analysis

4. Reduce Refund Costs

Finding: Total refund amount is ■2,289,755.42

Metric: Average refund: ■2,593.15 per returned item

Action: Focus return reduction efforts on high-value product categories

Evidence: Based on 883 returned items

9. Methodology & Limitations

Return Rate Calculation: Returned eligible orders ÷ Total eligible orders × 100. Eligible orders include Delivered, Returned, and Refunded statuses. Cancelled orders are excluded.

Limitations: (1) No delivery date fields available — delivery delay analysis not possible. (2) No seller identifiers — seller performance uses category-level proxy. (3) No product size field — size-related analysis not possible. (4) Correlation does not imply causation — discount and return associations are observational.